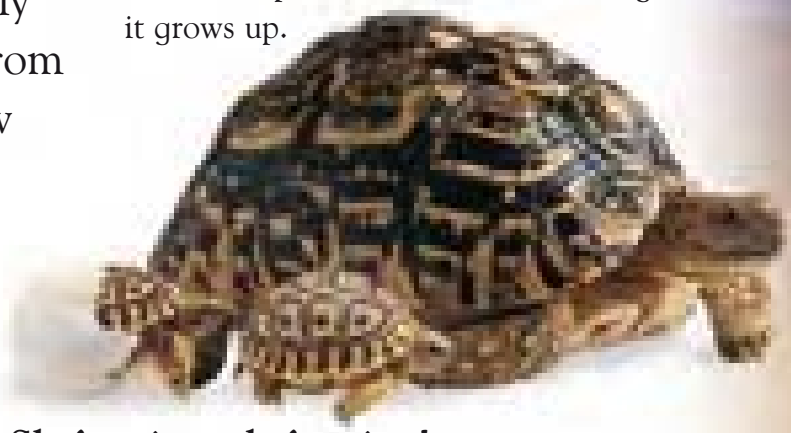
Little devils

Like most animals, male and female reptiles mate to produce offspring. Reptiles are usually born on land. Most hatch from waterproof eggs, while a few are born as live young.

Chips off the old block

Whether hatchlings or live young, reptile babies usually look like miniature versions of their parents. The baby leopard tortoise will develop its darker, adult markings as it grows up.





She's mine, she's mine!

As the mating season begins, male monitors often wrestle each other. The fight is just a "display" for attracting a female mate, and the weaker lizard usually gives up before either one gets hurt.



The not so great escape

Snakes lay eggs with soft, leathery shells. The hatchlings have a special "egg" tooth, which they use to tear a hole in the shell – but it can take up to two days for a baby snake to fully emerge.

Reptiles with fewer young make the more caring parents.

Reptile file

- Reptile babies are often left to take care of themselves.
- Lizards and snakes that hatch inside the body of the mother usually have a greater chance of survival.
- Marine turtles can lay as many as 200 eggs in one go.



Ready-made babes

Lots of snakes and lizards give birth to live young – just like human beings do – rather than laying eggs. They emerge in little membrane sacks, but escape from these very quickly.